

DAY 4 POULTRY INTERMEDIATE LEVEL

AGRI_EMPOWER POULTRY BOOTCAMP: DAY 4

MODULE 3 & 4: POST-HARVEST, PROCESSING & VALUE ADDITION

GOAL: MAXIMIZE VALUE AFTER PRODUCTION

Success in poultry isn't just about how many birds you raise; it's about how much money you keep after the final sale. This module focuses on the "Business of the Bird."

1. MARKET TIMING: WHEN TO SELL

- **The Weight Peak:** Broilers reach their peak efficiency between **6–8 weeks**. After this, they eat more feed but gain less weight (FCR becomes poor). Keeping them longer eats your profit.
- **Holiday Planning:** At the Intermediate level, you must time your stocking so your birds reach target weight 1 week before major holidays (Easter, Sallah, Christmas) when demand and prices are highest.

2. LIVE BIRD VS. PROCESSED SALES

- **Live Sales:** Fast cash, low labor, but you are at the mercy of "middlemen" who negotiate prices down.
- **Processed Sales:** Higher profit margins. You sell the "convenience" of a ready-to-cook bird. This allows you to reach supermarkets, hotels, and busy urban professionals.

3. THE PROCESSING CHAIN (SOP)

- **Slaughtering:** Birds should be fasted for 6–12 hours (water only) before slaughter to reduce gut bacteria and contamination.
- **Dressing:** Use a clean scalding tank (53–55°C) for easy feather removal. Over-scalding cooks the skin and reduces shelf life.

- **Chilling:** Immediately after dressing, birds must be cooled in "slush ice" or a refrigerator to stop bacterial growth.

4. STORAGE METHODS

- **Fresh (Chilled):** Stored at 0–4°C. Must be sold within 2–3 days.
- **Frozen:** Stored at -18°C or below. Can be kept for months, allowing you to "hold" stock until prices improve.
- **Loss Reduction:** Use **FIFO (First-In, First-Out)**. The first bird into the freezer must be the first one sold.



BUSINESS INSIGHT: WHY FARMERS LOSE PROFIT

Most farmers lose money at the point of sale because:

1. **Lack of Scales:** Selling by "eye-balling" instead of weight. Middlemen will always under-estimate the bird's weight.
2. **Desperation:** Selling all 100 birds at once to a single wholesaler at a massive discount.
3. **No Packaging:** A bird in a plain black nylon bag looks "cheap." A bird in a branded, transparent bag looks "premium."

Value Addition Ideas:

- **Cut Parts:** Selling wings, drumsticks, and gizzards separately often yields **15–20% more profit** than selling the whole bird.
- **Marinated Chicken:** Selling "spiced and ready to grill" chicken targets high-end consumers who pay for time-saving.



PRACTICAL WORKSHOP: PROFIT COMPARISON

Scenario: You have 100 birds at 2.5kg each (Total 250kg).

- **Option A (Live Sales):**
 - Wholesaler offers ~~₦~~4,500 per bird.
 - Total Revenue: ~~₦~~450,000.
- **Option B (Processed & Portioned):**
 - 20% weight loss during dressing (250kg becomes 200kg meat).
 - Selling processed parts at ~~₦~~3,000 per kg.
 - Total Revenue: ~~₦~~600,000.
- **The Result:** Even after paying ~~₦~~30,000 for labor and packaging, you make **₦120,000 more** by processing.